
Section 3.3 Marriage and the family

Students will be required to: demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the specification; express their own responses to the issues and questions raised by the specification using reasons and evidence; evaluate alternative points of view about these issues and questions.

Key words — adultery, civil partnership, cohabitation, contraception, faithfulness, homosexuality, nuclear family, pre-marital sex, procreation, promiscuity, re-constituted family, re-marriage

- Changing attitudes to marriage, divorce, family life and homosexuality in the UK and the reasons for them.
- Christian attitudes to sex outside marriage and the reasons for them.
- The purposes of marriage in Roman Catholic Christianity and how this is shown in the wedding ceremony.
- Different Christian attitudes to divorce and the reasons for them.
- Christian attitudes to homosexuality and the reasons for them.
- Roman Catholic teachings on family life and its importance.
- How Roman Catholic parishes help with the upbringing of children.
- How Roman Catholic parishes help to keep the family together.
- Different methods of contraception and the reasons for them.
- Different Christian attitudes to contraception and the reasons for them.
- How an issue arising from marriage and the family has been presented in one form of the media, for example in a television or radio programme, or in a film, or in the national press; including whether the treatment was fair to religious beliefs and religious people.